

Commute + Community

More space. A longer drive. What works for your life?

OPTION A

OPTION B

Work / regular destination:

Typical hours:

01 Test the real route

Drive each route at your expected departure and return times. Record the round trip, including typical traffic. Check how many trips you actually make; hybrid schedules count.

Your inputs	Option A	Option B
Driving days per week		
Driving weeks per year		
Round-trip commute miles		
Round-trip commute minutes		
Actual average vehicle MPG (use your own records)		
Usual gas price (\$ per gallon)		
High gas price to stress-test (\$ per gallon)		
All-in housing cost (\$ per month)		
Other added travel costs (\$ per month)*		
Paid replacement for family help (\$ per month)**		

Housing: payment/rent, taxes, insurance, HOA and upkeep. * Include tolls, parking and added vehicle maintenance. ** Include childcare, rides or other help you would need to replace. Enter \$0 only if none applies.

02 Calculate the tradeoff

Annual miles = round-trip miles x days/week x weeks/year
Monthly gas = annual miles / MPG x gas price / 12
Annual driving hours = round-trip minutes x days/week x weeks/year / 60

Your calculated results	Option A	Option B
Annual commute miles		
Monthly gas at usual price (\$)		
Monthly gas at high price (\$)		
Annual commute hours		
Monthly total at usual gas price (\$)***		
Monthly total at high gas price (\$)***		

*** Housing + gas + other added travel costs + paid replacement help.

Which option fits you?

Rate each option from 1 to 5. Then give each factor an importance from 1 (low) to 5 (high). Higher option ratings mean a better fit for you.

1 Driving enjoyment

1 = draining | 3 = tolerable | 5 = enjoyable, even after a long day

After the route test: How would this drive affect your energy, evenings and weekends?

A rating: ____ B rating: ____ Importance: ____

2 Vehicle + fuel comfort

1 = high-price gas strains budget | 3 = manageable | 5 = comfortably affordable

Use actual MPG and both gas prices. An efficient car can still cost more with extra miles.

A rating: ____ B rating: ____ Importance: ____

3 Family + reliable help

1 = needed help becomes hard to reach | 3 = workable | 5 = support stays accessible

Map childcare, eldercare, rides and emergency help. Count time and paid replacements. If proximity matters little, give this factor less importance.

A rating: ____ B rating: ____ Importance: ____

4 Hospitals, schools + daily essentials

1 = an important need is unmet | 3 = workable access | 5 = strong verified fit

Check hospital/provider services and insurance; school address boundaries, programs and enrollment.

A rating: ____ B rating: ____ Importance: ____

03 Map support and protect your must-haves

Who helps / with what / how often / travel time from each option?

My must-have (e.g., care, school program, support or commute limit):

Verified with / date: _____ A: pass / fail B: pass / fail

A failed must-have overrides the score. If a fact is unverified, pause that decision and check it directly. This worksheet compares your needs; it does not rank neighborhoods.

04 Optional fit score + your next step

For each option: $\text{sum}(\text{importance} \times \text{rating}) / \text{sum}(\text{importance}) = \text{a 1-5 fit score.}$

A: ____ B: ____ What would make the harder choice workable? _____

The score is a reflection aid, not a scientific recommendation. Want help checking both options? Bring this worksheet to Kareem: (818) 402-7326 | kareemjamaltherealtor.com